

PROSPER AWUNI

Cyber Security Vulnerability and Emerging Threat Specialist

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer specialising in vulnerability management, emerging threat analysis, and security operations across large enterprise environments. With over five years of progressive experience, I have built and led vulnerability management programmes using industry-leading tools including Tenable.io, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), and Nessus — delivering risk-based prioritisation and remediation tracking at scale. I have strong hands-on experience with Microsoft Sentinel (formerly Azure Sentinel) as a Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform, developing analytics rules, Kusto Query Language (KQL) queries, and threat hunting content mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework. I am equally experienced in threat hunting, security operations monitoring, and incident response, and I bring a structured, intelligence-led approach to identifying and mitigating emerging threats before they materialise into incidents. I thrive in environments where security is taken seriously and where I can contribute both technical depth and strategic thinking to protect complex, high-value organisations.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Pentera BAS, Nessus — programme design, scanning, risk-based prioritisation, stakeholder reporting
- **Emerging Threat Intelligence:** MITRE ATT&CK framework; threat intelligence integration; adversary tradecraft analysis; Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) using Pentera
- **SIEM:** Microsoft Sentinel (Azure Sentinel) — workspace design, data connectors, analytics rules, workbooks, KQL-based threat hunting; CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM
- **Threat Hunting:** Proactive hypothesis-driven hunting across endpoint, cloud, identity, and email telemetry; MITRE ATT&CK-aligned hunting methodologies
- **Security Operations Monitoring:** Alert triage and investigation; Security Orchestration, Automation, and Response (SOAR) playbook authoring; CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and XDR
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 lifecycle; senior escalation lead; post-incident review and lessons-learned reporting
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Microsoft Defender Suite:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK, JISC
- **Scripting:** PowerShell, KQL

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Lead the vulnerability management programme across a hybrid cloud and on-premises estate, using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS to identify, prioritise, and track remediation of vulnerabilities based on risk to the organisation
- Conduct Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) exercises using Pentera to continuously validate security control effectiveness and identify emergent attack paths aligned to real-world adversary techniques
- Perform proactive threat hunting across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon telemetry, developing KQL-based hunting queries and detection rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK emerging threats
- Monitor and analyse security events across SIEM, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), and cloud security platforms; triage and investigate alerts, distinguishing emerging threats from false positives

- Author and maintain the organisation's threat intelligence-informed incident response playbooks in line with NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK threat actor profiling
- Serve as senior escalation lead for complex security incidents, conducting end-to-end investigation and post-incident review
- Present vulnerability management metrics and emerging threat briefings to the Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) and senior leadership, translating technical risk into business impact
- Collaborate with infrastructure and cloud teams to ensure timely remediation of critical and high-severity vulnerabilities, tracking progress against agreed Service Level Agreements (SLAs)

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 – March 2025*

- Designed and operated the vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io and Nessus, producing risk-prioritised remediation reports and tracking resolution across the estate
- Developed and tuned Microsoft Sentinel SIEM analytics rules and KQL threat hunting queries to identify anomalous behaviour and emerging threat patterns across cloud, endpoint, and email data sources
- Conducted proactive threat hunting exercises, leveraging MITRE ATT&CK intelligence to formulate hypotheses and hunt across CrowdStrike Falcon and Sentinel telemetry
- Investigated SIEM and EDR alerts, performing root-cause analysis and coordinating containment and remediation activities
- Authored threat intelligence-informed incident response playbooks, ensuring consistent response procedures mapped to known adversary techniques
- Monitored threat intelligence feeds and emerging vulnerability disclosures, assessing organisational exposure and recommending mitigations
- Managed Azure AD / Entra ID Conditional Access and MFA enforcement, hardening identity controls to reduce the attack surface

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) — IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 – March 2022*

- Performed vulnerability assessments across infrastructure and application layers, coordinating remediation with development and infrastructure teams
- Monitored security alerts for anomalous or threatening activity and supported incident investigation and containment
- Supported ISO 27001 compliance including risk assessments, security policy review, and access control audits
- Maintained awareness of emerging threats and security advisories, communicating relevant risks to the security team

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Established a mature, risk-based vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS, enabling prioritised remediation aligned to real-world threat intelligence and reducing critical exposure across the estate
- Introduced Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) to continuously stress-test security controls against emerging attack techniques, providing the CISO with evidence-based assurance of control effectiveness
- Developed a library of MITRE ATT&CK-aligned KQL hunting queries and Microsoft Sentinel analytics rules, improving detection coverage for emerging threat actor techniques
- Led Cyber Essentials Plus certification, directly remediating vulnerability findings and demonstrating compliance with the UK Government's cybersecurity baseline
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across 8,000 users, providing comprehensive endpoint and identity threat visibility
- Built a CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM detection engineering capability, creating custom detections mapped to emerging MITRE ATT&CK techniques and significantly reducing dwell time

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering

- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 75,000–80,000 | Hybrid (London/UK)